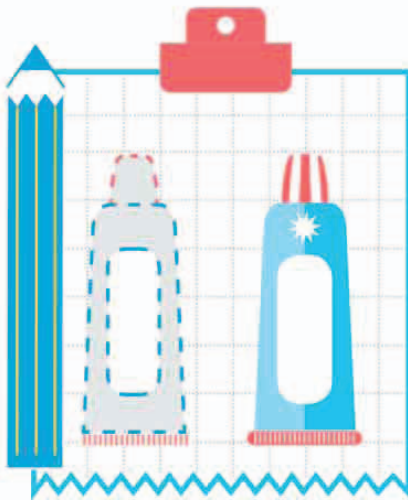


**\$3.6**  
trillion  
the value of goods  
traded between EU  
member states in 2013

### PRODUCT LIFE SPAN

Home entertainment offers different products to consumers. These are four examples of products at different stages in their life cycle (see pp.184–185):

- **Introduction** 3-D televisions—only recently available for the home
- **Growth** Blu-ray players—steady increase in sales because of enhanced viewing experience
- **Maturity** DVD players—challenged by more sophisticated technology
- **Decline** Video recorders—cheaper and more modern viewing formats now available



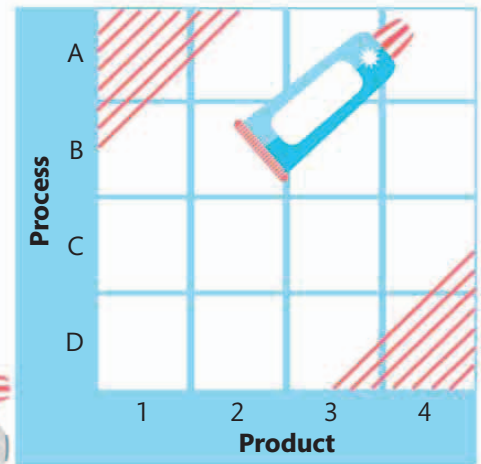
### Packaging and design

The toothpaste tube is given a bright, clean, and attractive look. Design considerations include functionality, expense of materials, and an appeal to current trends. See pp.306–307.



### Quality management

A period of quality control begins, in which standards of safety and comfort are thoroughly checked. It is far cheaper to correct defects in the design phase than later in production. See pp.308–309.



### Product-process matrix

Using a product-process matrix, the company identifies the correct production method for the toothpaste. Because the company makes only a few products, each at a high volume, it decides to use assembly-line production. See pp.310–311.